Trouble at Boston and the Boston Tea Party

In March of 1770, British soldiers found themselves being hit with snowballs by the colonists. The British soldiers, instead of dealing with the situation maturely, killed five and wounded another six with gunfire. Six out of the eight soldiers were acquitted of the crimes. The other two were punished for manslaughter, which meant that their thumbs were branded. The Americans were outraged at the British for not executing anyone.

Three years later, the British East India Company arrived in Boston to sell 298 boxes of tea. At the time, Boston hated the British and so a number of Americans disguised themselves as natives and dumped the tea into the water. This would later come to be known as the Boston Tea Party. The Prime Minister at the time was Lord North who imposed a succession of new laws known as the Intolerable Acts. Boston's port was shut down and the administration center transferred to Salem.

More resentment occurred when the British attempted to gain the loyalty of the French Catholics through the Quebec Act in 1774. They had effectively allowed the borders to expand to the south and west of Quebec. Believing that the British wanted to relocate the French Catholics in the region to gain more power, the Continental Congress arranged a meeting. They wished for both of the previous acts to be repealed so Americans could assert their own laws and taxes.

In the same year, Joseph Galloway attempted to make a compromise. He suggested that the American colonies should create a Grand Council and let the Crown select a president general. The Continental Congress voted for the idea but the British refused to compromise with the colonists. In February of 1775, the British government announced Massachusetts to be in rebellion and sent British forces to handle the situation.

The Americans resisted by forming their own militia. In April of the same year, the British tried to take control of an American arms supply close to Concord but the Americans had been forewarned about British intentions. The Americans faced the British in a battle and eight Americans were